

DS Capstone Topic

Evelyn Salgado

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Project discipline: Economics

Faculty advisor: Prof. Karla Cordova

Description

My capstone project aims to examine whether the cost of basic necessities in a state relates to child wellbeing outcomes. This will be tracked across American states from roughly 2013 to 2023. I will be looking at two main data sets: Bureau of Economic Analysis's Regional Price Parities (RPP) and the Annie E. Casey Foundation's KIDS COUNT data. The RPP measures how expensive goods and services are in a given state relative to the national average, while KIDS COUNT provides state-level indicators on child health, economic security, and family wellbeing. The specific KIDS COUNT indicators used will be finalized in consultation with my advisor.

Data

This project requires joining two independently structured data sets. The BEA RPP data will be reshaped into a usable format and standardized on a common state identifier to align with KIDS COUNT. Once joined into a single state by year panel, I will address missing or incomplete years and generate descriptive statistics and correlation measures to characterize the relationship between cost of necessities and child outcomes.

Advanced Method

I aim to build a multilevel regression model to account for repeated observations within each state. I will then develop an interactive Shiny application as an advanced data visualization.